[M[IRZA] BABA TO CHARLES BURGESS[19]] *Tuesday, November 26, 1833*

His Excellency the ameer Nazim[20] heard that you left this today for Ardibel. He desired Jahangar Khan Shahgie to send some people to accompany you as far as Ardibel and bring letters both from you and Fate Ali Khan, that you are safely arrived there, so send letters stating your safe arrival. Get from Fate Ali Khan at Ardibel to give you horsemen to escort you to Tallish and so on, and at every opportunity let us hear from you both your health and safety.

[CHARLES BURGESS TO HENRY BURGESS] *Risht, Province of Ghilan, February 1, 1834*

I write you these few lines to inform you, that, yesterday, the last parcel of the silk I have purchased here was despatched for Tabreez, and that tomorrow morning "Inshallah" I follow. We are now in the depth of winter, and I have the tremendous chain of mountains called Elbūrz to get through, therefore it is possible I may meet with some delays on the road, but they cannot be of much importance as this year very little snow has fallen comparatively. This letter I despatch by a "Kansed" or foot messenger, who I am despatching to Edward in Tabreez, and who will of course arrive many days before I can, having ninety mule loads of silk to look after.

The actual quantity I have purchased will be in English lbs. about 26,000. I might have gone much more largely into the speculation, but as prices here are comparatively high, I feared a fall, and thought it not prudent to invest too large an amount in one article. I have made some other purchases of Caviar, Gum, and some of the manufactured silk of this country for trial in England, but the amount is not considerable. If the last quotation from Constple holds good, silk will yield a profit of 20% at the prices I have purchased here, and as all the crops even from China of last Autumn must be come to market, I cannot but consider the speculation as holding out a fair and reasonable prospect of advantage. Edward will have made some purchases in Tabreez, the proceeds of which will, I trust, have reached you long ere this, of the exact amount of E's transactions I am unacquainted.

It gives me great pleasure to inform you, that, the death of the poor Prince Royal[21] has not in the slightest degree affected the internal tranquillity of Persia, nor is there any ground for fearing confusion until after the death of the Present

[19] Mirza Baba and other names in this letter are presumably those of local chieftains. The only importance of this letter is the indication that Charles has returned to the East.

[20] *Amr i nizam*, "chief of the army."

[21] Abbas Mirza, died in 1833.

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